until China either engages in a war with Japan, or to punish these murderers and to hold permanently the southeast coast of Formosa, and to prevent murders and outrage especially as it is a much frequented coast beating to windward in a northeast Monsoon.

I also wrote to Genl Babcock and asked that the President would look to the matter and prevent any interference on the part of our Minister with what was in progress.

I will probably hear in a day or so of what has been done and will inform you without delay.

We are all very well and will be glad to see you when you come.

I do not doubt that the President will correct any action on the part of the State Dep't that may tend to embarrass Japan in so useful an undertaking.

Sincerely Yours
(signed) Dan'l Ammen.

No 10. Peking, October 11th, 1874.

Your Excellency:

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch of the 19th of September, from which I am gratified to learn that my action in publishing the pamphlet entitled: "Is Aboriginal Formosa a part of the Chinese Empire?" has been approved. In connection with your recommendation that I should carefully acquaint you in detail with everything interesting to H. I. J. M's Government that may come under my notice, I beg to state that I have not been directly

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connected with the negociations now going on between Mr. Okubo and the Tsungli Yamen, but have derived all my informations concerning these negociations verbally from Mr. Okubo direct, or through the medium of one of his secretaries, Mr. Yoshiwara; and consequently it would be difficult for me to commit these communications to paper for your information without incurring the risk of being inaccurate. Therefore, I must refer you for details upon this important subject to the despatches of the High Commissioner.

My position here has been a difficult one, and not such, I must confess, as would have enabled me to render such services to the Government as I had anticipated when I left Yokei.

At the time I was appointed Special Commissioner to the Provincial Authorities of Yeh Kyen, I was expecting to meet with quite a different position from that which circumstances afterwards placed me in; for, as you are aware, I had in Southern China two influential friends who, I knew, were actively engaged in promoting the interests of peace between Japan and China. These friends were, at Amoy the Taotai, and at Foochow Wan Yeh, the ranking officer of the province, both of them Tartars and relations of the Emperor. Wan Yeh had been for three years the Tsiang Kiun, or Field Marshal and Superintendent of Finances, at Foochow, at the time that Ho Kuei (another friend of mine) was Governor General of Yeh Kyen and Chekiang. This latter office, since leaving his post at Foochow, has been promoted

twice in succession - first to be President of the Board of War at Peking, and afterwards President of the Civil Board and Captain-General of the Gendarmeries. This last appointment (which is the third highest in the Government service) he received on the day after my arrival at Peking. Both Wen Tsh and Li Hung Chi are indebted to me for services rendered to them in my official capacity while I was U. S. Consul at Amoy such as no one worthy of the name of man could ever forget. They have since proved that they have not forgotten them, and that their confidence in me as an honest man and an officer is entire. Both of them have great influence at Peking, and I had reasons to believe that Li Hung Chi, like Wen Tsh, was anxious that peace should not be broken.

My course of action in going to Tsochow, therefore, was very clear. I would have seen Wen Tsh and furnished him with arguments founded upon the defenceless state in which China was at that time, and also upon the dangers which would threaten the dynasty from the rebellions which would certainly break out in every part of the Empire on the announcement of a war with any foreign power, & had entertained the hope that Wen Tsh would take advantage of his influence with Li Hung Chi, who, as I have already said, was inclined for peace, to bring the force of these arguments to bear upon the councils of the Emperor, and thus strengthen the position of Mr. Yamagiwara, who, I knew, was instructed to co-operate with me in making moderate demands upon the Cabinet of Peking.

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You are aware of the circumstances by which I was prevented from making any attempt to carry these plans into effect immediately after my arrival in Southern China. Subsequently, the despatch of Mr. Okubo to Peking as High Commissioner, armed with full powers, whereby the Tsung li Yamên was compelled to assume the sole conduct of the negociations, which had hitherto been partly left in the hands of the Provincial authorities, rendered useless any visit of mine to Tchefoo after my release from arrest at Shanghai.

When I met Mr. Okubo in Shanghai, I understood from him that Mr. Yanagiwara had been instructed to bring the subject of my arrest to the notice of the U.S. Chargé d'Affaires, with a view to obtain such explanation as would enable me to assume my Peking duties as semi-official attendant with both my Chinese friend Sir Rutherford and the foreign ministers as I could not take so long as this had not been done by H.E. Mr Mitchell; and the High Commissioner, justly apprehending that my position in Peking would be embarrassing so long as the conference between Mr. Yanagiwara and Mr. Williams on the subject of my arrest would be going on, advised me to delay my departure from Shanghai one week, to allow time for all such matters to be adjusted.

But I learned, on my arrival at Peking, that Mr. Yanagiwara, being of the opinion that, since I had been unconditionally released by order of the Chargé d'Affaires, who had thereby tacitly acknowledged the illegality of my arrest,

it would but be taking an unnecessary risk of incurring his enmity, or, at least, displeasure (which he might show by embarrassing the action of the High Commissioner in Peking,) were he to place my case before him, has abstained from doing anything in the matter. As there was much to be respected in these reasons, and Mr. Okubo endorsed them, I did not endeavor to press a different view; but I suggested that the instructions under which I had been sent to Tientsin, and the subsequent change made in the object of my mission, should be communicated to the Tsung li Yamên. But to this, Mr. Yanagiwara also objected, on the ground that it is not customary for the Gaimusho to notify Central Governments of the appointment of Special Commissioners to either local or provincial authorities.

Now we must consider that one nation stands in the same light towards another nation as does the proprietor of one house towards the proprietor of another; and that, if a private individual should send one of his house servants to the servant of his neighbor on any business whatever without apprising said neighbor of his intention, it would be a grave breach of etiquette, so also when one Government sends one of its servants on a mission to the servant of another Government, the latter Government should be notified of said mission; and I held that it was right for the Japanese Government to notify the Government of China of the mission I had been called upon to fulfil at Tientsin.

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But not wishing to raise a controversy in a matter in which I was so exclusively interested, and thus cause anxiety to the High Commissioners at a time when they had other and more serious subjects to occupy them, I refrained from insisting on a further discussion of the question, and determined to make the best of the position in which I was thus placed to serve Mr. Okubo to the best of my ability, and with all the devotion which was due to his high rank and character, and to the personal attachment which I have formed for him.

I have already furnished you with my Memo. No. 35, sent to Mr. Okubo on the 19th of last month. On the 8th instant, I had a protracted interview

with the High Commissioners, in the course of which they did me the honor to give me a full account of their proceedings since their arrival in Peking; and they asked me to furnish them with a written memo. of my views of the situation in as brief delay as possible. Accordingly, on the following day, I forwarded to him my Memo No. 36, copy of which I now beg to enclose. (See Enclosure No 1.). On the morning of the 10th instant, Mr. Okubo sent the Tsungli Yamen a despatch which I have not yet seen, but which I have understood to be a sort of ultimatum. In the course of the day I had occasion to see the Marquis de Geofroy, the French minister, who

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who said to me that he would gladly improve any opportunity that might be offered him to aid in maintaining peace between Japan and China. My impression is, that in saying this, he was sincere, and that he is favorably inclined towards Japan. I thanked him for his kind words and replied that, as the interests of Strangers in the East were so inconsiderable, I, personally, would be glad to hear that he had been placed in a position that would enable him to bring about an amicable settlement of the difficulties now pending between Japan and China, for I was quite satisfied that the views he would take of these difficulties must be quite impartial and conformable to the laws of equity

and justice, and therefore in accordance with those of Mr. Okubo, but quite in opposition to those which, so far as I knew, the Government of China, as represented by the Tsung li Yamên, had given expression to during the conferences.

A few days previously I had seen Mr. Williams, the U.S. Chargé d'Affaires, who had expressed this readiness to assist both China and Japan to preserve intact their good relations. But I regret to say that, in two or three instances, he had given such evidences of partiality towards the Chinese that I should be sorry to hear that he had had an opportunity to carry out his wishes.

Mr. Wade, the English Minister, must have been much influenced by the

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views of Sir Harry Parkes, and therefore I consider them to have been hostile to us at first. From enclosures Nos. 2 and 3 however, you will perceive that lately he has considerably changed his views.

Both the Russian and German ministers went to Mongolia shortly after Mr. Okubo's arrival in Peking. I think the former would not be sorry to see hostilities break out between Japan and China, in the hope that they would bring about a dissolution of the Chinese Empire, whereby Russia would obtain many facilities for the carrying out of her schemes of territorial aggrandizement in Western Asia. But I think his sympathies are with Japan. I was confirmed in this opinion by what

I heard at the house of the Russian Consul-General, whose hospitality I enjoyed while in Orenburg. When I was taking leave of him the day I started for Peking, I asked his wife what I could do for her in Peking, and whether I could not get something for her there. To which she replied: "I would like you to bring me the first brick that will be knocked down by a cannon shot when the Japanese take Peking!" Today, Mr. de Butzow called upon me, and in an informal conversation that lasted about an hour, he gave no evidences of any sympathy for China.

What I have said of Russia, I may also say of Prussia, although

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the interest taken by these two countries in a war between Japan and China would not be the same. I think that Prussia intends not to mix herself up in the quarrel at all; and I do not believe that I risk too much when I say that not one Western power will come to interfere in case of a war between the two countries, now that the efforts of Mr. Okubo have made it apparent to every one that Japan has not desired a conflict, but would gladly avoid one if China shows signs of any desire for peace during the present negociations; and that, if she must resort to arms, it will not be with a view of conquest, but solely to uphold the honor of her flag and vindicate her rights; and

therefore China, and not Japan, must be held responsible for the consequences. The hint which Mr. Wade gave to Mr. Pitman (Enclosure No. 2) that, in case hostilities should actually break out between China and Japan, England might be compelled to interfere, is to be received more as a confirmation of my views than otherwise. For, if England had decided to take this step, Mr. Wade would not have given such a poor reason for his action as the one he furnished to Mr. Pitman. Doubtless he telegraphed to his Government, and received the answer that he should remain strictly neutral. Were this not so, he would not change so suddenly his tone. The information which he gave to Mr. Pitman to the effect that the

Tsovchow loans of six millions of taels had not been approved by the Central Government was calculated to show that the Cabinet of Peking had given up the idea of fighting, and would yield to the demands of Japan if a sufficient pressure should be brought to bear upon them; and therefore this information may be considered as coming from a friend.

Regarding military matters I have very little to say in addition to what I have had the honor to write you in my previous communications. I will merely remark that, in my opinion, the fortifications which have been erected on the banks of the Peiho by Li Hung Chang are but of little importance, as they could easily be turned, if it should

enter into the plans of the Government to make the North of China the scene of operations in case of war. This, however, I consider would be a mistake; for an invading army would suffer greatly from the cold if sent in that direction, and, besides, they would have to meet in the field the very best troops in the Empire, there being about 20,000 of them at Jehol, and 15,000 at or near Pekin. (See Mr. Pilman's Report. Enclosure No. 4 (a). So long as the Cabinet of Peking will have reason to believe that these troops will be wanted for the defence of the capital, they will retain them at the North, in which case they will be unable to send them to the South after the cold weather has set in,

(a). Mr. Pilman's information and mine does not appear to tally.

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as the roads are impassable for an army in the winter time.

It seems to me that Southern China, in the winter, would offer a much more favorable field for the operations of the Japanese forces. The country is rich, populous, and full of everything that an army can need; while the climate is not very cold. Neither is it well defended; for the only troops they have there are raw recruits, badly armed and equipped, who can not be organized in less than six months, and who, I firmly believe, will not fight in any case. That for a long time past there have been no regular troops in Southern China, is proved by a memorial sent in reply to an Edict of the

Emperor, in 1870. by Tso Tsung, who was then Governor General of Suh Kiang and Kheliang. At that time, the Chinese thought that a war was imminent with France; and as the causes that led to such a state of affairs as is spoken of in the memorial have not changed since 1870, it is evident that matters must still be in the same condition as they were then. The authenticity of this document (a copy of which I beg to enclose) I can vouch for; as it was bought by me in 1870, together with other papers showing that some of the local authorities had spread a report among the people to the effect that the foreigners had devised a scheme to

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poison all the rivers and wells in China; and the fact of my having obtained from the American Government the concession that these papers should not lead to diplomatic correspondence, which the anti-foreign sentiments they contained would have warranted, is the cause of my intimacy with Dr Kwei and Wun Teh, which I have spoken of above.

But to return. The first success of the Japanese arms at the South would, in my opinion, be the signal for the breaking out of revolts in Kwang-Tung, Yuh-Kyew, the Central Provinces and Formosa, which, on the coming of Spring, would give the troops left at Peking quite enough to keep them occupied, without their

thinking of going South to meet the Japanese. Then, if the commanders of the Japanese forces are careful to impress upon the Chinese population the fact that the war is not directed against them, but against their Government, and if they do not molest them, I firmly believe that a treaty of peace, highly advantageous to Japan, would soon be established, either with the present Government or with the new power that would be erected on its ruins by the victorious Chinese patriots. To this effect, if it should become necessary to declare war, it would be good policy for the Government of His Imperial Japanese Majesty to issue a proclamation in Chinese that

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may be easily understood by the people, stating that the intentions of His Majesty in making war upon China is not in any way to harm the people, but only to overthrow the Manchu dynasty, for which, as every one knows, the Chinese entertain a deep hatred. This would not only foment among them the seeds of discord, from which, in case of a war with China, Japan might expect to derive as much assistance in accomplishing her object as from her own troops.

I will forward this despatch at once, and will write you again in a few days to give you some information which I expect to receive from Chinese sources, and as quickly

upon with the receipt of Mr. Okubo's ultimatum.

I have the honor to be,

Your Excellency's

Most Obedient, humble Servant,

Chas. W. Le Gendre

His Excellency

Okuma Shigenobu,

Minister of Colonization,

&c. &c. &c.

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Memo. No. 36.

I.

It has been the Custom from the Oldest Times, before declaring War, to Show to Neutrals the Causes of resorting to it.

War is just only when resorted to from actual necessity, or founded upon absolute right. Should those who direct the Councils of nations ignore this principle, justice would be perverted, passion and caprice would be substituted for feelings of reason and equity in the breasts of monarchs and rulers, and human safety and happiness, becoming thenceforth a vain sport in their hands, would disappear from the earth. This is why, in all cases of war, whether just or unjust, the opening of factual hostilities on the part of the aggressive party has, from the remotest antiquity, been followed by a public announcement of the reasons which it has for thus taking up arms. The first part of the great oath, as recorded in the founth book of Shoo King, is nothing but a manifest on the part of Woo Wang, , to his vassals in justification of his aggression against Chow, , (1121 B.C.). If we pass from remote antiquity to modern times, we find that the same custom prevails. When, in 1741, the King of France resolved to wage war against Maria Theresa, the Empress-Queen of Hungary, he gave his reasons for so doing in a manifest addressed to all the Courts of Europe. When, in 1806, the Emperor of Germany declared war against Napoleon I, he issued a manifest wherein he explained why he had been thus called upon to disturb the peace of the world. Even in cases where war has been undertaken solely from motives of policy, manifests have been issued containing arguments in justification of the declaration of war entirely foreign to the real motives. For instance, the war which broke out in 1754 between France and England, was announced by the latter power as being justified by the violation of the limits of Nova Scotia and acts of violence committed by the French in Canada; while the real motive was to destroy the power of France on the sea, which was becoming a source of anxiety to Britain. The late war between France and Russia was commenced with the view of repressing certain internal causes of dissension in the former country which Napoleon III. thought himself unable to remove in any other manner, and which, if allowed to

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developed, might have caused the downfall of himself and of his dynasty. But the reasons which he gave to the world for thus breaking the peace of Europe were, as every one knows, entirely foreign to this.

"

What are the just Causes for War?

The following are considered as just causes for war:
1st — The violation of the fundamental rights of a state.
2nd — The dispossession by force by one state of the territory or any portion of the territory of another state.
3rd — An act whereby the foundations of order and right which it is so essential to maintain in the human family, are threatened with destruction. (Kleinschrod's International Law Codified, § 676.)

"

Has Japan any just Cause of War against China?

The question now to be answered is whether China, by her attitude, or by her acts, has given to Japan sufficient causes for the latter at this juncture to declare war against her.

To reply to this question, I must first examine what the causes of difference between the two nations are.

"

Review of the Causes of Difference existing between the two Countries.

"

On the 19th of December, 1871 (5th day, 11th moon, 10th year of Tung Chi) fifty four Japanese of the Liu Kiu Archipelago were murdered in cold blood by the Bantans, a tribe of aborigines in Formosa; and shortly afterwards another party of Japanese castaways were molested by this tribe.

These acts excited the attention of the Japanese Government, who had lately established a line of mail steamers between Hakodadi and their ports of the Liu Kiu islands, whose crews were apt to come to grief upon the inhospitable coast of Formosa.

A careful examination of the standard works of geography shows that the island of Formosa is divided into two parts, viz. the western portion, occupied by Chinese, and the other, or eastern portion, by aborigines, who claim for themselves an unrestricted independence and authority over the region they inhabit. A reference to various records shows that China has never exercised any sovereignty over these aborigines.

It has also been ascertained that these aborigines do not, like the American Indians, lead a wild life; and that their cruel practices upon castaways is solely owing to a hatred for strangers which has originated, and is being daily increased, from the ill-treatment suffered by them at the hands of Chinese Adventurers, whose acts the Chinese Government, from the time it gained a foothold in the island in 1683 (30th year of Kang-hi) up to the present day, have never made the slightest attempt to repress.

Public records also show that the aborigines have become so incensed at this ill-treatment, that they refuse to have any political intercourse whatever with the Chinese; although, in certain cases, they have consented to enter into agreements with persons coming to them in the name of other powers.

In this manner, in 1867 and 1869, the United States made agreements for the protection of Castaways with some of the Southern tribes.

Japan's desires of having the same protection extended to her people as has been obtained for Americans, determined to send a mission to the Bantans. The experience of America had demonstrated that, to be successful in this peaceful mission, a large armed force must accompany her representatives, to give emphasis to the words of conciliation and peace which he was instructed to speak to the natives in the name of Japan. This she determined to do; but, inasmuch as the spot where her forces must land in Formosa was near to the Chinese establishments in that island, as an act of courtesy towards H. I. C. M's government, she announced her intention to H. through her ambassador at Pekeng. That this was really done, and that no objections were made by China to the undertaking, but quite the reverse, is officially recorded in a letter from the Tsung li Yamen to the Minister of Foreign Affairs of Japan dated the 26th day, 3rd moon, 13th year of Tung Chi (May 11th, 1874).

As announced, the mission started for Formosa. Its chief duly notified the local Chinese authorities of his approach near that island, and of his arrival there, stating to them that, if a large armed force had been brought, it was intended for no other purpose than to protect the mission in its humane labors; and he concluded by begging them to cooperate with him, which they agreed to do; and they actually gave effect to this agreement by inviting their subjects on the coast of the island to lend him their aid. But shortly afterwards, the Chinese Government, as represented by the "Viceroy" of Fohkien, under whose jurisdiction are the Chinese possessions in Formosa, taking umbrage at the rapid progress of Japan in carrying out her announced purpose in Formosa, which they had never anticipated would be accomplished, and allowing themselves to entertain an unjust suspicion that Japan, being likely to be induced to establish herself there, would become to China a dangerous neighbor, suddenly changed their tone;

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and the Japanese expedition, which the Yamên had hailed with good wishes but one year previously, was objected to in the strongest terms. While endeavoring to prove his point, the Viceroy quotes the French author Vattel, and the principles of international law as laid down in a Chinese translation of the American writer, Wheaton, made by Dr. Martin, and adopted by the Chinese Government.

Alarmed by this change, Japan lost no time in sending her minister, Yanagiwara, to Pekin to ask for explanations. The minister was coldly received and notified that he could not be received by the Emperor so long as the difficulties between Japan and China, caused by the sending of the Formosa mission, should remain unadjusted.

Yet, at the time Mr. Yanagiwara arrived in Peking, peace reigned between the two empires; and therefore the refusal to receive him may be considered as a rupture by China of her friendly relations with Japan. (a) For the sending of the Formosa mission by Japan, having been encouraged by the Chinese Government when the subject was first broached to them by the ambassador Soyeshima, and afterwards countenanced by them immediately on his arrival in Formosa, cannot therefore be considered by China as a just cause of complaint against Japan.

With a view of removing the cause of this sudden interruption by China in the good relations between the two countries, Japan has now sent to Peking a High Commissioner, whose mission it is to adjust, directly with the Central Government, the Formosa difficulty, as first brought to the notice of the Japanese Government by the letter of the Viceroy of Fokkyen to General Saigo.

The High Commissioner, having arrived in Peking, immediately placed himself in regular communication with the Tsung li Yamên. In laying them (alleged) causes of complaint against Japan before General Saigo, the chief of the Formosa mission, both Western and American authors had been quoted by the representatives of the Chinese Government at Foochow. On meeting the ministers of the Tsung-li Yamên on the ground of discussion selected by them, the High Commissioner had attempted to refute the arguments of the Chinese by quoting these same foreign authors. But now the ministers of the Yamên refuse to give him any reply, apparently upon the ground that, in discussing the question on this basis, he is acting in violation of the treaty obligations between China and Japan and is trying to force upon China the newly-adopted customs of Japan, one of which is to regulate all her foreign intercourse by reference to international law. The High Commissioner has tried to remove this impression, but is not listened to; and a discussion upon the ground first selected by China, as stated above, is declined by the Tsung li Yamên.

(a). Néanmoins le refus de recevoir en temps de paix le ministre d'une puissance peut être regardé comme une rupture, si ce refus n'est pas fondé sur des raisons plausibles. (Le Guide Diplomatique, par le Baron Charles de Martens, tome premier, page 45.)

Upon what Ground may Japan feel justified in declaring War against China?

Outside of the declarations that aboriginal Formosa, the possession of which they disclaimed but one year ago, now belongs to China, and that its territory, which they once said Japan might freely enter because they had no claims to it, she must now evacuate because China intends to occupy it, the ministers of the Tsung li Yamên refuse to articulate a single syllable for the consideration of the High Commissioner, or to listen to anything that he may say in support of the position of his own country.

These strong affirmations on the part of the members of the Tsung-li Yamên, and which they refuse to back by any arguments, are certainly calculated to give offence to Japan, inasmuch as they are to be taken by her more in the sense of imperative demands than as requests founded upon reasons considerately submitted; and although this language is somewhat tempered by Continual assurances of the good will entertained by China towards Japan, yet it is rendered particularly significant by the extensive preparations for war now going on in every part of the former country.

These preparations, considering the disproportion which exists between China and Japan in the extent of their territory and their resources in men and money, constitutes a danger for Japan which may eventually threaten her in her very existence as a state. This danger she is, in self-defence, bound to remove at all hazards; and if, in the relative positions of the two countries, perhaps as prompt house-thrust at her giant adversary would, after all, be her best parry.

Courses which may be followed by the High Commissioner to convince the World that he came to Peking on a Mission of Peace, although his Mission may ultimately end in a Declaration of War by Japan against China.

But the mission of the High Commissioner to China is not one of war, but is essentially one of peace; and he should endeavor to fulfill this mission as long as possible.

This being the case, the High Commissioner might request of the ministers of the Tsung li Yamên:

First. That they will substantiate, in writing, the claims of China to that portion of Aboriginal Formosa which has been occupied by the Japanese troops at the mountain town of Chinia, within five days from the date of their receiving such request, at the same time notifying them that, upon their failure to do so, he will consider his mission at an end and will leave Peking.

Second. That, within the same space of time, a day shall be fixed for the reception of Minister Yanagiwara by the Emperor, or else a solemn declaration shall be given by them that such a day shall be fixed at some ulterior date, in the manner customary with the Court of Peking in their dealings with the representatives of Western powers and America; notifying them that, should they refuse to do so, such refusal shall be considered as an evidence on their part of a desire to break relations with the Court of Japan, and Minister Yanagiwara shall accordingly leave Peking.

Third. That, within the same space of time, they shall give to Japan, through her High Commissioner, a satisfactory explanation of the reasons which have induced China to make the extensive preparations for war now going on in her dominions; failing which, the High Commissioner shall consider himself justified in looking upon these preparations as being directed against Japan, and shall accordingly warn his government to guard against the danger in the best manner it may.

The Interests of Peace may be promoted by the Adoption of this Plan.

By these acting, the High Commissioner, without compromising the honour of Japan, will

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powers to step in and use their influences in obtaining from China the admissions, concessions and assurances which Japan has been asking for, and upon the attainment of which seems to depend the maintenance of the peace between the two countries.

"

The Adoption of this Plan may ultimately work favorably to Japan by affording her Facilities to Complete he War Preparations, and avoid Interior Troubles.

"

The adoption of this plan may be caused to finally result favorably to Japan by the representatives of a friendly power whom the High Commissioners may select as the medium of communication between the two Governments, should either of them have anything to say to the other after the departure of Japanese representatives from Peking. By proceeding slowly, seven days will elapse from the time the High Commissioners shall have left Peking until he will be ready to embark from Tientsin for Japan, a length of time amply sufficient for the foreign Chargé d'affaires of Japan to ascertain whether there will be any grounds kept of maintaining the peace between the two Countries, and to let the High Commissioner know if there be any before he leaves Tientsin for Japan. Fifteen days more may be made to pass before the arrival of the High Commissioner in Japan, in which time the Government of Japan can determine what course to pursue, and if they incline for war, can at once complete their preparations to resist an attack on the part of China, or to carry on a war against that country, which they would be justified in declaring upon the grounds specified above. The time that would elapse between the departure of the High Commissioner from Peking and his arrival at Tokei, might be usefully employed by the Government of Japan in secretly informing the people of their intentions, and of their reasons for delaying the declaration of the war, thereby avoiding the internal disturbances which might take place were their real intentions to be misunderstood.

Peking, October 9th 1874.

Respectfully Submitted -
(signed) Chas. W. Le Gendre.

His Excellency
Okubo Toshimichi,
H.I.J.M. High Commissioner,
Etc. Etc. Etc.

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Enclosure No 2.
with Despatch No 10.

Minutes of Conversation with
Mr. Wade, representing his views
On the subjects discussed.

— " —

Admitting that the Chinese Government
memo a have not clearly established their right to the territory
xpedition. invaded by the Japanese (although in Mr. Wades
Experience of 30 years he has always considered it as
part and parcel of the Chinese Empire) and admitting
likewise that the Japanese Government in invading
this territory only thought they were acting in accordance
with the understanding arrived at by Mr. Soyeshima
still, there was an informality attending the preparation
and despatch of the expedition without advice of any
kind to the party whose territory was to be invaded
and who, at all events, by occupation had interests
which might be endangered and who should have
received some notice to the effect that this expedition
was sent in accordance with previous understanding
at Peking, and requesting the Chinese authorities to
give notice of the object of expedition to any of their
subjects in the territory to be invaded - This
informality, coupled with the reserve maintained
throughout by the Government in Japan and also
by Mr. Okubo here to the foreign representatives,
precludes the representatives from forming any
other opinion than that to be formed by the facts
of the case as they have occurred, and by the

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explanations offered by the Chinese Government who throughout have placed the whole correspondence connected with this matter at the disposal of the foreign representatives. Far from the foreign representatives wishing to back up the Chinese, their sympathies naturally are with Japan as they universally condemn the isolation and obstructive policy of the Chinese Government, and Mr. Wade refers to his unreserved views on this matter which he explained to Mr. Soyeshima.

But although they would wish to see things different to what they are in China, still throwing back on the facts of the case as they appear and the impossibility of hearing the Japanese view of it, they are compelled to think China has apparent grounds for complaining of unjust treatment. China also complains that at the present moment territory (admitted by Japan to be theirs) is or has been occupied by Japanese troops.

The reason of Mr. Wade's anxiety to obtain explanation of intentions of Japanese Govt. from Mr. Okubo.

Mr. Wade was anxious that his motives for a somewhat unusual diplomatic course of repeatedly inquiring from Mr. Okubo some explanation of the intentions of his mission, should be clearly understood, viz: the importance of the interests of England at stake in the event of a rupture between Japan and China, he considered that these interests amounting to an annual trade of $250,000,000 would be endangered by a war, and therefore he considered it his duty to be persistent in his inquiries from Mr. Okubo, but at the same time he acknowledged Mr. Okubo had a perfect right to decline to supply him with the information, but this placed him (Mr. Wade) in the position of feeling that England's interests

were jeopardized and being unable to inform the English Govt. to the contrary he had been compelled to telegraph to increase the English fleet on the station so as to guard against the interference to English ~~interests~~ interests in case of war.

The effect of war upon foreign interests.

It was impossible for foreign powers to interfere with the right of China or Japan to declare war against each other. But that in his position as representing England with such enormous interests at stake in China, he felt it to be his duty to do all in his power to preserve peace and friendly relations between China and Japan. Neither France, Germany, America or Russia have any such interest as England has in this matter. England having such an enormous trade, the ramifications of such a trade are so very great that it is difficult to see how a war would not in a short time bring about a difficulty between England and one or other of the combating powers, and amongst other troubles likely to arise he is afraid that the inexperience of China and Japan in maratime warfare will be the means of attracting to this part of the world a lot of unprincipled men (the refuse of European countries) who will endeavour to prey upon foreign vessels under shield of the Japanese or Chinese flags and so add to the complications of war.

Corea.

With regard to this question Japan has apparently good grounds for taking action and she would probably receive the sympathies of foreign powers.

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In the interest of Peace Mr. Wade would be willing to use every endeavour if required and he cannot help thinking that China would accept any reasonable terms proposed to her.

Preservation of Peace between China & Japan.

On other Matters of Interest.

It appears that the $ 6000.000 borrowed by the Viceroy of Foochow on the security of Chinese Customs at Foochow for the purpose of purchasing Ironclads has been refused confirmation by the Peking Government.

Li Hung Chang has sent an old resident of Tientsin to England by last mail ostensibly to purchase Mining Machinery for opening coal and iron mines in this neighbourhood. But there is no evidence that this is other than a step to gain popularity with Foreigners and also as a blind to Japan, as no arrangements have been made for the outlay proposed.

Enclosure No 3.
With Despatch No 10.

Copy

In a conversation held on the 13th with Mr. Wade I explained to him that the reason why Mr. Okubo had not been able to communicate his proceedings to him was that the negociations had not reached the point at which he felt himself at liberty to lay the matter before him & that he fully understood the interest England had in the matter & should have much pleasure in calling upon him in the course of a few days & explain matters. Japan had as yet only negociated on points referring to her honor & which she considered only concerned China and herself, and that the question of indemnity was a secondary point. Mr. Wade said this view of the case was clear to him and Japan's position was perfectly logical and he thought ought to command the consideration of the Chinese Government.

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Enclosure No 5,
with Despatch No. 10.

Minutes of a Conversation with Mr. Hart on 12th Oct.

Referring to the fact that Japan was really exercising considerable influence over affairs in China by inducing the Government to adopt a less exclusive policy in many measures, and that it was to be hoped this beneficial influence would continue,

Referring then to the present difficulty between China and Japan, Mr. Hart said it was one of those complicated cases which was doubtless capable of solution but it was difficult to see how to approach it. He inquired if a money indemnity would satisfy Japan and what amount of indemnity Japan would require. His reply was that I knew nothing about what Japan required, but I thought that a money indemnity was a secondary consideration. What Japan felt most was the slight cast on her honor. Mr. Hart concluded by stating there were four days yet in which it could be arranged.

(Signed) John Pitman

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Enclosure No. 4 with Despatch No. 10.

神機營官弁兵丁總目

		和碩醇親王
		大學士文祥
		尚書崇綸
總理神機營事務王大臣		侍郎恩承
		侍郎榮祿
		專操大臣應差
		副都統景瑞
計開署內各等處		
印務處	官四員 弁兵十二名	文案處 官十八員 弁兵二十四名
營務處	官四十員 弁兵六十名	摺奏處 官四員 弁兵八名
糧餉處	官六員 弁兵十二名	支發處 官二員 弁兵六名

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No. 11. Peking, October 17th 1874.

Your Excellency:

In my despatch No. 10. of the 14th instant, I promised to give you information received through Chinese sources. I had first intended seeing Dr Kwei, but I was debarred from doing this by the necessity which became apparent to me to lead the British Minister, who is much opposed to me, to believe that I had very little to do with the negotiations now going on; and this I could not have done had I had a conference with Dr Kwei, of which Mr. Wade would have been certain to hear and would have thought it was with the knowledge of Mr. Okubo; and now that the British Minister is so well disposed and will, in my opinion, continue so as long as he sees a chance of working in accord with Mr. Okubo without fear of my stepping between him and the High Commissioner, I have thought it dangerous to awaken his suspicions. On the other hand, I

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(25)

核對處 官四員 弁兵十六名　收文處 官四員 弁兵八名

署外設立

軍器庫 官十六員 弁兵二十四名　軍火局 官弁同上 鉛丸火藥一切 由部局副領

洋槍威遠隊

精字隊 督操 景瑞 明惠 管帶各官在外洋槍兵八百七十五名 各帶 俄國製造銅帽槍

捷字隊 督操 誠應 祥順 教目同上

銳字隊 督操 德壽 恩佑 教目同上

勝字隊 督操 文秀 通格 教目同上

震字洋礮隊 帶隊官成章 洋炮兵五百名 炮車二馬拉所有之炮俱是俄國製造綠色車俱用火熕放每輛用二馬六兵

駿字洋馬隊 官弁一千名

在清國 古柱堂城謙

驤字洋馬隊 官弁一千名　各帶法国製小短馬槍俱用已改成之鉛丸

圓明園馬隊管帶大人岳林 官弁一千六百名 各帶中国舊用火繩點放

圓明園抬槍隊管帶大人托雲 兵一千六百名 大槍八百桿 各代中国大舊用火繩点放

防務府幼丁技藝隊管帶大人興林 弁兵五百名 各代中国土様器械

健銳營馬隊管帶大人榮祿 弁兵五百名 各代中国火繩槍

健銳營洋槍炮隊 槍兵八百七十五名 炮兵一百二十五名 健字隊 代俄国銅帽槍 代法国自箭九銅炮

外火器營馬隊管帶大人恩振 抬布 弁兵五百名 各代中国火繩槍

外火器營洋槍砲隊 槍兵八百七十五名 砲兵一百二十五名 利字隊 各代俄国銅帽槍 各俄国銅炮

內火器營馬隊營大 西蒙克什克 弁兵五百名 各代中国火繩槍

十處頭起馬隊 官弁兵丁五百名

十處二起馬隊 同上

五滿黃旗隊管帶大人伊崇阿 弁兵五百名

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神機營馬步中外各兵總目

精

洋步隊隊 勝 各有八百七十五名

銃

香山洋步隊八百七十五名

藍靛廠洋步隊八百七十五名

共有洋步隊兵五千二百五十名

以務府五百名

中步隊五蒲黃五百名

左翼各一千名

右

在清國 古賀當城譲

左翼驍騎抬槍營管帶大人博崇武 弁兵五百名

右翼驍騎抬槍營管帶大人署任安興阿 弁兵同上 各代中國大火繩槍

第二

八漢排槍籐排營管帶大人尚宗瑞 弁兵一千二百名

八漢礮隊帶隊官成明 弁兵一千名 各代中國大小銅製炮大小鉛丸

中營小隊技藝隊帶隊官富森布 弁兵二百名 各代中國大樣器械保護之者

外有

烏里雅蘇臺自北京至該處六千里在 俄國 印度國 交界

後遠城有一千五百洋槍兵至該處一千里由北京

歸化城至北京一千二百里一千兵各處均有神機營撥去槍砲官弁兵丁

營 口五百兵

with Mr. Okubo without fear of my stepping
between him and the High Commissioner,
I have thought it dangerous to awaken
his suspicions. On the other hand, I

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共七百五十名　共砲三十二
中国砲隊一千名
共中外歩隊一萬二百五十名
共中外馬隊五千五百名
共中外砲隊一千七百五十名
共合一萬七千五百名

八漢一千二百名
中営二百
圓明園一千六百名
共中歩五千名
洋馬隊共二千名
内火五百
中馬隊十處一千名
圓明園一千名
香山五百名
藍靛廠五百名
共三千五百名
洋砲隊 霞字五百 共砲二十四
藍靛廠一百二十五砲四

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京營十處官兵單

鑲黃旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名　管營大人一員
正黃旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名　小官弁在兵丁數內
正白旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名
正紅旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名
鑲白旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名　管營大人一員
鑲紅旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名　小官弁都是同上
正藍旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名
鑲藍旗護軍營兵一千八百廿名

共官弁兵丁一萬四千名

左翼前鋒營兵一千五百名　管營大人一員
右翼前鋒營兵一千五百名　小官弁兵丁數目在內

同上

森清國古狂堂城謙

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奏為閩省沿海地方遵
旨密籌防範謹將辦理情形恭摺覆
奏仰祈
聖鑒事切臣承准軍机大臣密寄同治九年六月二十五日奉
上諭現在各省沿江沿海口岸設立防兵能否真實可靠著英
桂嚴飭各該處帶兵各員隨時訓練實力整頓並將現在辦
理情形詳細具奏等因欽此伏查各國傳教名為勸人行善
宜則流毒無窮蓋華民入教者皆非安分之徒其教士又多
方包庇遂有所挾持任意欺害良民即無迷拐採割之事已
稍至不相容鮮緣易啓訟洋人動以兵船恐嚇凡有血氣者
莫不痛恨同深天津一案實由洋人藉端肆毒激成衆情憤

在清國 吉狂堂城謙

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恐群起而攻不免陰憶疑慮經臣 率屬
臣 復密飭治海道員各於係護之中兼寓防範之法切思通
商口岸各国均有教士洋商並瞎中聯為一气而明則各立
門戶倘佈置稍露聲色則彼族共啓猜猻尤恐內地奸民乘
机生事設或別生枝節在彼更易藉口恭繹
諭旨飭疆臣 瞎中維凡洋人之情勢均在
聖明洞鑒之中 臣 擬將福州一口先統平日操演之兵假保護
弹壓為由重加簡選新任福建陸路提臣 江長貴現已到閩
署提臣 羅大春史卸在即已密函囑其史部後迅速来省統
率所選各兵認真訓練實力整頓應否另行募勇調兵候羅
大春到省 臣 與福州將軍文並在省司道會商妥籌福州治
海一帶團練皆志切同仇隨時堪以號召總理船政大臣沈

怒非一朝一夕之故也然法国過事尋衅今殺其領事洋人
毀其教堂旗幟彼必以戰相挾遂非理之請無厭之求治海
各省誠不可不亟等防範閩省治海口岸向無專設防兵自
同治三年以来特有大隊楚軍分札遣用近因庫藏支絀節
次將勇裁撤現任上下游者皆係地方緊要所留輯捕每處
不過二三百名或數十名不成隊伍至
本鉅自款兵以後亦覺地大兵單隸水
提 臣 總兵親率標防隸省標省由 臣 與
訓練技藝漸精若令禦侮折衝不敢謂真寔可靠然兵气之
強弱全在統領之轉移即如水陸提標兵丁經 提 臣 李成謀
羅大春訓練得力此其明證也 臣 就閩省情形再三籌度現
在福州廈門台灣通商三口各国教士洋商固屬天津之信

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